

► **DAY 3**

**Inclusive
Supports in
Education**

- **Education Assistant Program**
- **Instructor Leonie Stephens**

Day 3 Agenda

- ▶ Essential Support vs Universal Support
Assessment
- ▶ Informal/Formal
- ▶ Summative vs formative
Individual Education Plans
- ▶ Types of IEPs: Traditional & Competency Based IEPs
- ▶ Components of the IEP
 - Goals, Objectives, Strategies & Evaluation
 - Data Collection (complement PBIS)
Exploring IEPs
 - Collaboration & IEPs
Confidentiality
Supporting non-designated students
Natural Supports
Ways to Step Back

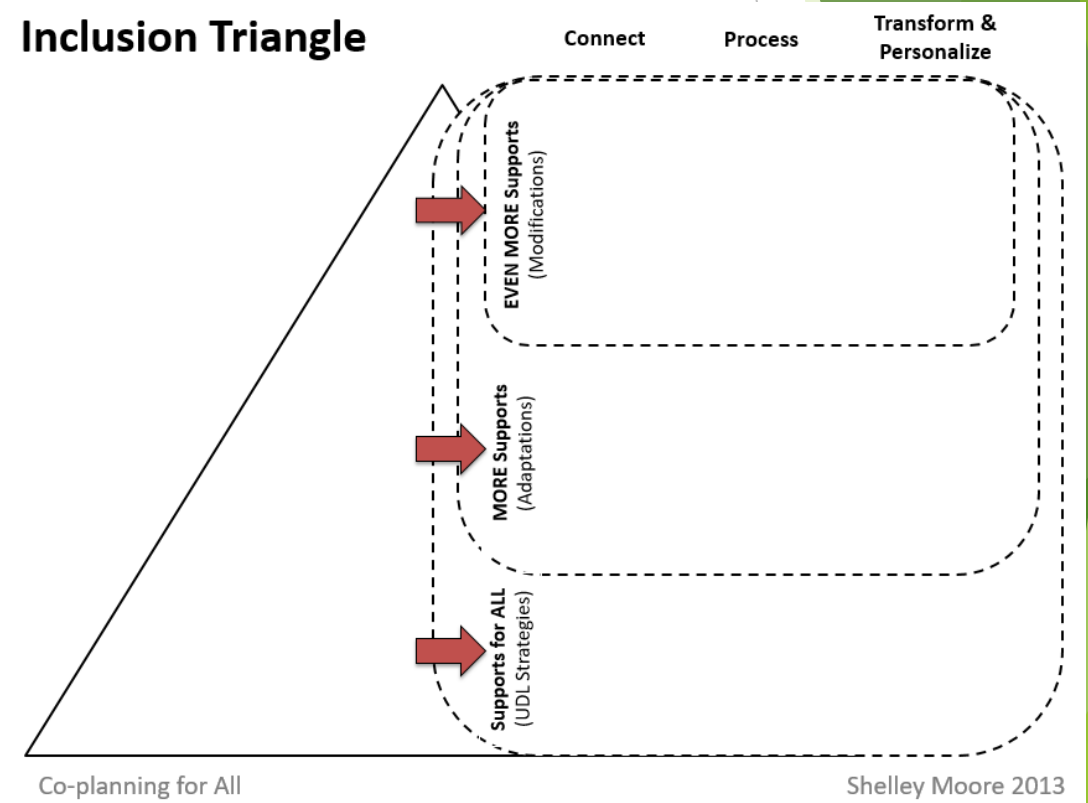
Essential Supports vs Universal Supports

- ▶ **Universal Classroom Supports:** These are supports that could be made available to any student to foster greater inclusion in the classroom.
- ▶ **Essential Supports:** These are supports identified through psycho-educational and/or medical testing and are necessary in order for the student to access the curriculum. They may require the use of technology or the direct involvement of specialist support staff

Universal Supports

- While not every student will require the same supports, there are a few key elements that should be in place in order to effectively provide an inclusive learning environment for all students.
- What are some of the universal components of inclusive learning environments?

Inclusion Triangle



Universal Supports

Universal supports include:

- Ongoing classroom assessment (running records, district reading assessment, phonological awareness literacy service, basic reading inventory, math boxes, writing rubrics...etc.)
- Variation in content, process and product in lesson planning
- Use of flexible grouping
- Respectful learning activities (engaging and appropriately challenging)
- Use of research based educational practices
- Proactive, school-wide approach to behavioural interventions
- Cultural responsiveness is part of core instructional programming
- Supplemental instructional materials are used when needed.
- Parent communication and involvement

Universal Supports

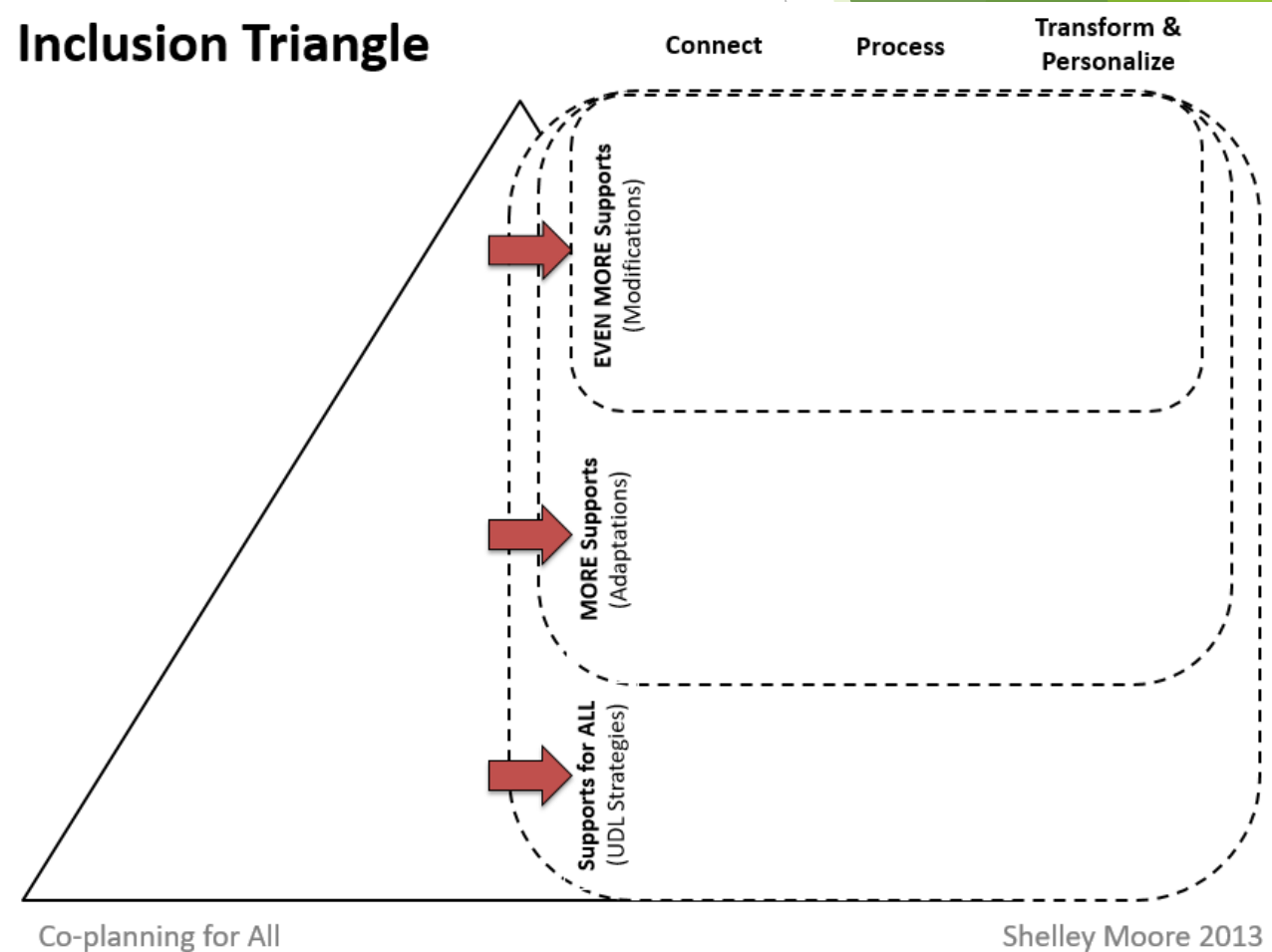
Universal supports include:

- Understanding history of student strengths and areas of need
- Use classroom or grade-level volunteers to tutor small groups or individual students
- Collaboration with student services facilitator and administration related to instructional and behavioural strategies
- Meet with specialists (PE, music, art, technology, teacher librarian) for support and suggestions
- Cooperative learning and peer support strategies
- Classroom level “contracts for success” and/or goal-setting
- Implement meta-cognitive strategies throughout lessons

Essential Supports

- Essential supports can be thought of as specific support (adaptation) or individualized goals (modifications) based on student's needs
- What are some of the essential components of inclusive learning environments?

Inclusion Triangle



Essential Supports

Examples of Essential Supports

- Use the same materials but have students interact with only part of them (e.g., half the problems on a worksheet)
- Change the format of materials but keep the same general level of challenge (e.g., convert an assignment from essay to multiple choice or matching)
- Supplement the classroom materials by adding audio-visual media, models, manipulatives, etc.
- Substitute different materials (e.g., a synopsis of a book, chapter summaries, content-area reading materials at a different grade level)
- Provide technology (e.g., scan text or worksheets into the computer and manipulate them to enlarge, highlight, remove distractions, change how answers are entered; provide the student with an augmentative communication device)
- Enhance materials: enlarging, putting fewer words on each page, creating borders or other visual supports, using colors, adding symbols or photos to text

Essential Supports vs Universal Supports

Show what you know: Is the support essential or universal?

- Braille
- Preferential seating
- Fewer questions
- Big Mac
- Designated reader
- Graphic Organizers
- Use of a calculator
- Service dog
- Simplified Instructions

Assessment

Classroom assessments are an integral part of the instructional process and can serve as meaningful sources of information about student learning. Feedback from ongoing assessment in the classroom can be immediate and personal for a learner and guide the learner to understand their misconceptions and use the information to set new learning goals.

Assessment

Proficiency Scale				
	Emerging	Developing	Proficient	Extending
	The student demonstrates an initial understanding of the concepts and competencies relevant to the expected learning.	The student demonstrates a partial understanding of the concepts and competencies relevant to the expected learning.	The student demonstrates a complete understanding of the concepts and competencies relevant to the expected learning.	The student demonstrates a sophisticated understanding of the concepts and competencies relevant to the expected learning.

Self - Assessment

The Student Reporting Policy requires all students (K to 9) to complete a self-assessment of the core competencies at the end of the school year. The goal of the self-assessment requirement is for students to describe themselves as learners in relation to the core competencies and to gain greater ownership of their learning. In addition, students will often be asked to complete a self-assessment on their learning.

Self - Assessment

Students, teachers and schools have flexibility in the format of the year-end self-assessment. Some examples include:

At the elementary level these include:

- ▶ Written summary
- ▶ Portfolio review
- ▶ Self-assessment transcribed by the teacher
- ▶ Mind map or graphic organizer of student's strengths and goals
- ▶ Video of a teacher and student interview
- ▶ Student-created video outlining assessment of the core competencies

Formative & Summative Assessment

Formative (practice)

- ▶ Use to check students' progress
- ▶ The information gained guides the next steps in instruction and helps consider the additional learning opportunities needed to ensure success
- ▶ Formative assessment information must be fed forward into an instructional model that allows for responsiveness to student need
- ▶ Examples: Writing assignments, quizzes, asking questions

Summative (game)

- ▶ Provide information about the attainment of knowledge
- ▶ Results translate to an overall level of achievement
- ▶ The goal is to evaluate student learning at the end of an instructional unit
- ▶ Examples: A paper, tests/mid-term exams, projects & presentations

EAs Consideration during Formative and Summative Assessment

When you are *scribing* during assessment you should:

- ▶ Take direction from the student about where to begin the exam and how to proceed
- ▶ Present a neutral manner, being careful not to indicate a correct/incorrect response
- ▶ Record the student's responses word for word
- ▶ Punctuate according to the student's speech pattern when punctuation is not what is being assessed
- ▶ Enable the student to see the computer screen or written response to read and edit what is recorded
- ▶ Revise only upon specific request of the student
- ▶ A scribe may not ask leading questions, or provide suggestions or interpretations of any kind

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

An IEP is a documented plan developed for a student with special needs that describes individualized goals, adaptations and/or modifications, the services to be provided, and includes measures for tracking achievement.

It serves as a tool for collaborative planning among the school, the parents, the student (where appropriate) and, as necessary, school district personnel, other ministries and/or community agencies.

Individual Education Planning for Students with Special Needs (2009)

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

- ▶ A school board must ensure that an Individual Education Plan (IEP) is designed for a student with special needs as soon as the board identifies the student as having special needs.

IEP is **required** when:

- ▶ the student with special needs requires adaptations to materials, instruction or assessment methods and/or modification to expected learning outcomes,
- ▶ the student requires 25 or more hours of remedial instruction by someone other than the classroom teacher, in a school year

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

An IEP should include the following:

- ▶ The present levels of educational performance of the student;
- ▶ The setting where the educational program is to be provided;
- ▶ The names of all personnel who will be providing the educational program and the support services for the student during the school year;
- ▶ The period of time and process for review of the IEP

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

An IEP should include the following:

- ▶ Evidence of evaluation or review, which could include revisions made to the plan and the tracking of achievement in relation to goals; and
- ▶ Plans for the next transition point in the student's education (including transitions beyond school completion).

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines.

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

An IEP should have:

- ▶ A manageable number of realistic or achievable goals
- ▶ Measurable objectives
- ▶ Relevant strategies
- ▶ The means to assess, evaluate and track progress towards the goals.

Individual Education Planning for Students with Special Needs (2009)

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

Activity

- ▶ In your groups, review the Matrix IEP.
- ▶ What pieces of information are on the IEP?
- ▶ Large group discussion.

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

- ▶ IEPs are living documents.
- ▶ IEPs are for students with a Ministry designation receiving 25 hours or more of specialized support from someone other than the classroom teacher.
- ▶ IEPs contain assessment information about the student, their strengths and needs in addition to the goals, objectives, strategies and evaluation plan.

Individual Education Plans - Types

Different school districts and different school may use different types of IEPs and IEP formats.

- ▶ *Traditional IEPs*
- ▶ *Competency Based IEPs* which can be created using MyEducation BC (provincial database)
 - ▶ Supported by the Ministry of Education, this new format is designed to encourage student voice as active participants in IEP development, and link learning to the development of the core and curricular competencies of our redesigned BC Curriculum.

Individual Education Plans (IEPs)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F9erTfzbpec>

Writing Meaningful IEPs

Terry Wendorf

Provincial Integration Support Program

ACTIVITY:

- ▶ Share what stood out for you in this video.
- ▶ Large group sharing.

Individual Education Plans: *GOALS*

The IEP must set out:

- ▶ present level of educational performance (including strengths and needs);
- ▶ goals that correspond to the curricular areas that are adapted or modified;
- ▶ goals for students who are designated within a Ministry category which correspond to the category in which they have been identified;

Where the goals established for the student are different from the expected learning outcomes for the age or grade, these should:

- ▶ be set at a high but attainable level to encourage parents, students and staff to hold high expectations.
- ▶ be accompanied by measurable objectives developed for each goal to enable IEP review and evaluation.

Traditional IEPs: *OBJECTIVES*

After formulating the goals, the next step is to create *objectives*. They are focused, concrete steps toward the achievement of the goals.

Objectives break down the goal into specific, measurable and observable skill/knowledge components.

Well-written objectives provide clear guidance as to what the student is expected to achieve and provide a clear basis for monitoring student progress.

Individual Education Planning for Students with Special Needs (2009)

Traditional IEPs: *OBJECTIVES*

Creating measurable *objectives*:

- ▶ Make reference to a performance standard, rubric or developmental sequence;
- ▶ Indicate a rate: for example, state that the student will perform the task 3 out of 4 times; 80 % of the time, or 5 minutes out of every 10, with 75 % success.
- ▶ Define the factors surrounding the behaviour: for example, “when asked to work independently...”, “when transitioning to a new activity”, “in math class”, “after recess” etc.

Individual Education Planning for Students with Special Needs (2009)

Traditional IEPs: *OBJECTIVES*

Scenario: Frank is not yet using language to communicate.

GOAL: Frank will increase his communication using a communication board in social interactions with peers.

OBJECTIVE: Frank will have his picture board with him at all times. He will respond to his peers by pointing to an appropriate picture on his board 90 % of the time when asked questions by his peers.

Traditional IEPs: *STRATEGIES*

Strategies help the student to achieve the goals and objectives. The strategy section often includes:

- ▶ The approach and/or resources to be used;
- ▶ Where the activity will take place, how often, on what days, or in what time frame;
- ▶ The staff person who will work with the student.

Traditional IEPs: *STRATEGIES*

An IEP usually includes one or more of the following types of strategies:

- ▶ Provides intensive, direct instructional intervention (e.g. remedial or compensatory);
- ▶ Extends content for enrichment;
- ▶ Adapts the learning environment to enhance mobility or meet sensory needs;
- ▶ Provides alternative approaches to instruction and/or evaluation;
- ▶ Uses adaptive or assistive technologies;
- ▶ Provides specialized services (e.g. braille, orientation and mobility, speech and language, sign language instruction).

Individual Education Planning for Students with Special Needs (2009)

Traditional IEPs: *STRATEGIES*

Scenario: Frank is not yet using language to communicate.

GOAL: Frank will increase his communication using a communication board in social interactions with peers.

OBJECTIVE: Frank will have his picture board with him at all times. He will respond to his peers by pointing to an appropriate picture on his board 90 % of the time when asked questions by his peers.

STRATEGIES:

- ▶ Teacher will practice questions with Frank during the morning greeting.
- ▶ Education Assistant will prompt Frank visually if needed.
- ▶ Speech-Language Pathologist will model with the class how to ask “yes” or “no” questions as well as other questions that can be answered using a picture board.
- ▶ Frank will practice with office staff when he delivers attendance each morning and afternoon.
- ▶ Parents will use the picture board to help Frank share school news at home.

Traditional IEPs: *EVALUATION*

Once the goals, objectives and strategies have been identified, the next step is to plan for appropriate observation and data collection so the student's progress can be measured and reported.

Examples of evaluation tools include:

- ▶ Portfolios of student work;
- ▶ Checklists of student performance and/or behaviour (completed by teachers and education assistants);
- ▶ Rubrics and rating scales;
- ▶ Functional assessments;
- ▶ Student self-assessments.

Traditional IEPs: *EVALUATION*

Scenario: Frank is not yet using language to communicate.

EVALUATION: Speech-Language Pathologist will conduct an assessment of Frank's functional skills with his communication board at the end of each reporting period.

But...Times They are a Changing...



Competency Based IEPs

There is now a move in BC to have Competency Based IEPs

- ▶ The goals are *strength based*
- ▶ Presumes *competence*
- ▶ Involves the *student*
- ▶ Moves toward collecting evidence of learning that *shows growth* vs. mastery/proficiency
- ▶ Aligns to the outcomes of a common curriculum; i.e. the *Core Competencies*

Competency Based Goals

Historical & Deficit Based Plans – Made FOR students
What can't students do? How do we fix it?



Competency Based Plans – Made WITH students
What do I know? What can I do?
What is my next step?

Competency Based IEPs

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0OrntS8NrUY>

See Ya Later SMART Goals: Shelley Moore

Activity

- ▶ Share your reaction to this video.
- ▶ Large group sharing.

Competency Based IEPs

- ▶ All students need to develop the Core Competencies so they can transfer them to their life outside of school as adults. They're LIFE SKILLS.
- ▶ They are written as continuums of growth that represent the range of learners from Kindergarten to Grade 12.
- ▶ They aim to support students to set goals and self-assess their progress.
- ▶ They can be embedded into any area of learning.
- ▶ They fit nicely into *Personal, Social and Thinking* goals for the IEP.

Competency Based Goals

- Focusing on what student's **could do** rather than what they **should do**
- “**I can...**” or “**I know...**” statements or “**student can...**”
- Building on **strengths** to **support stretches** - not trying to “fix” weaknesses
- **Open ended** so they can be met in **multiple** ways, and places

Competency Based IEPs

Activity

- ▶ With a partner, review at the sample “Competency Based IEP”.
- ▶ What is different from the sample IEP handed out earlier today? How might these changes affect the student?
- ▶ Large group sharing.

Individual Education Plans: *Example*

- ▶ Kevin is a student in Grade 5. He has Autism and loves building, castles and knights, medieval weapons. He is getting more confident at reading and needs support for writing. He loves anything science and art related and is successful when he can move while learning.
- ▶ Kevin struggles with attention and need to build more strategies for when he feels frustrated. We are working on building his perseverance and engaging in activities that aren't a preference for him.
- ▶ We are also supporting Kevin by helping him to ask for help when needed and build skills to play cooperatively with his peers.

Individual Education Plans: *Core Competencies*

Using what you know about the Core Competencies:

- ▶ What I can statements could support Kevin's learning?
- ▶ With a partner or in small groups, and using the BC Curriculum Guide, choose one of two I can statements that could be used as IEP goals for Kevin.
- ▶ Be ready to share out in the large group

Individual Education Plans:

Core Competencies

- ▶ I can persevere with challenging tasks
- ▶ I can take ownership of my goals, learning and behaviour
- ▶ I can take some responsibility for my physical and emotional wellbeing
- ▶ I can participate in classroom and group activities to improve the classroom, school, community and the world
- ▶ I can solve some problems myself and can identify when to ask for help
- ▶ I am kind to others, can work or play co-operatively and can build relationships with people of my choosing

IEPs: Collaboration

The planning of an IEP can draw upon the knowledge and expertise of several people, depending on the needs of the student.

A case manager coordinates and manages the collaborative process.

IEPs: Collaboration

An **IEP Team** may include (depending on the needs of the student):

- ▶ School Staff (e.g. Learning Support Teacher, Education Assistant, Counsellor, Classroom Teacher, Aboriginal Support Worker, Admin)
- ▶ District Learning Support Services Staff (e.g. District School Psychologist; Speech-Language Pathologist; Occupational Therapist, Physiotherapist, Behaviour Specialist Teacher, Vision Teacher, Hearing Teacher, ELL Teacher)
- ▶ Community Service Providers (e.g. Child Welfare Worker, Mental Health Worker, Home Behaviour Analyst, Settlement Worker).

IEPs: Collaboration

Parents are a part of the IEP process.

Schools are required to offer parents an opportunity to be meaningfully consulted in the IEP process.

Students, where appropriate, may also be meaningfully consulted in the IEP process.

IEPs: Collaboration

- ▶ An IEP meeting is usually held in the fall with a review at the end of the school year. Parents are invited to this meeting.
- ▶ IEP progress is also reviewed at each report card.
- ▶ Interpreters are invited, when necessary, to meetings so that the parent may feel supported and better understand and communicate.
- ▶ Private home-based specialists or therapists are also welcome to attend IEP meetings if the parents so desire. Although home and school environments differ significantly, consistent strategies used in both places often prove to enhance success for the student.

Individual Education Plans

Activity: In your groups and using the scenario and goal assigned to you (Scenario A, B or C), brainstorm what your group thinks an objective, strategy and evaluation could be developed for a student's IEP.

SCENARIO A: Max is a Grade 2 student who is not able to communicate verbally. One goal in his IEP is to increase his communication skills.

SCENARIO B: Becky is a Grade 4 student who has been diagnosed with Autism. One goal in her IEP is to increase her social communication skills.

SCENARIO C: Kayley is a Grade 7 student who has an auditory processing deficit. One goal in her IEP is to increase her literacy skills.

Large group discussion on each of the 3 scenarios and goals.

IEPs and Your Role as an EA

What is your role when thinking about IEPs?

6.1 Designing programs and planning and organizing learning experiences for students with special needs

6.2 Implementing programs for students with special needs:
Delivery of service

6.3 Assessing, evaluating, reporting and recording student progress

<https://bctf.ca/uploadedFiles/Public/Issues/InclusiveEd/RolesandResponsibilitiesTeachersTAs.pdf>

IEPs and Confidentiality

All information gathered is confidential.

This means:

- ▶ The information content is considered sensitive
- ▶ The information should only be disclosed to authorized staff - you should not talk to others who are not part of a student's IEP team
 - ▶ Information can not be shared without parent consent
- ▶ All confidential information should be stored in a locked cabinet

Non-Designated Students

- ▶ Some students may not have a designation.
 - ▶ non-designated students/unidentified students
- ▶ Students who do not “qualify” for an IEP may have a Student Support Plan or a Personal Learning Plan (dependent on different district procedures). This is a plan, similar to an IEP, that identifies areas of need and goals.
- ▶ How could you see yourself supporting non-designated students in the classroom?

Natural Supports

Natural supports are those which already exist in the classroom for any student, such as the teacher or peers. Peers can be a natural support to each other in the school.

For a number of reasons, this type of natural support is not always extended to students with significant disabilities.

<http://www.engagingalllearners.ca/sal/peer-mentoring/index.php?id=3>

Natural Supports

Natural supports are also relationships, interactions, assistance, connections and resources. They enhance inclusion, belonging, contributions and quality of life for students with and without disabilities.

From: The Golden Rule of Providing Support in Inclusive Classrooms: Support Others as You Would Wish to Be Supported by Julie N. Causton-Theoharis

Natural Supports

“Natural-support advocates have argued that the escalating level of increasingly specialized services provided to people with disabilities is a negative trend that has the following effects:

- Unnecessarily isolates people with disabilities.
- Creates unnecessary and unnatural dependencies.
- Interferes with the development of natural relationships and supports.
- Disrupts participation in school activities.
- Causes inequities in the distribution of scarce resources.
- May not be economically viable.”

From: The Golden Rule of Providing Support in Inclusive Classrooms: Support Others as You Would Wish to Be Supported by Julie N. Causton-Theoharis

Natural Supports

In this short video clip, Dr. Erik Carter discusses what natural supports are and why they are important for all students, including those with significant disabilities.

Video #1 Importance of natural supports [1:25]

Questions for discussion

- What statements in this video caught your attention? Why?
- What natural supports for students currently exist in your school?
- What barriers might students with significant disabilities experience accessing natural supports in the classroom and within school?
- How could you ensure students with significant disabilities in your school connect with the natural supports that exist in your school community?

Natural Supports - Peer Mentors

In this short video clip, Dr. Erik Carter explains why peer mentors have great potential for providing natural supports to students with significant disabilities.

Video #2 How peer mentors can provide natural supports [1:11]

Key understandings

- Peers are the most available and natural sources of support in any school.
- Peers are generally willing to provide some of the social and academic support needed by their classmates with significant disabilities.

Questions for discussion

- How might peer mentors provide social support for classmates with significant disabilities?
- How might peer mentors provide academic support for classmates with significant disabilities?

<http://www.engagingalllearners.ca/sal/peer-mentoring/index.php?id=3>

Natural Supports - Peer Mentors

Words of advice:

- Using peer mentors will also depend on your classroom teacher
- A discussion should take place with your classroom teacher and learning support teacher
- One should not rely solely on peer mentors

What would your role look like when a peer is supporting another student? Let's watch the next video to learn what we can do differently.

Natural Supports - Peer Supports

In this short video clip, Dr. Erik Carter describes how the role of the educational assistant in the classroom could shift to more actively facilitating positive peer interactions.

Video # 3 - How educational assistants need to work differently [2:01]

Key understandings

- The role of the educational assistant can shift from supporting individual students to supporting all students in a classroom.
- Other roles for educational assistants could be to facilitate peer interactions and model support strategies that students can use with their peers.

<http://www.engagingalllearners.ca/sal/peer-mentoring/index.php?id=3>

Natural Supports - Just Enough Supports

In this short video clip, Dr. Erik Carter discusses considering other forms of support before arranging individualized one-to-one adult-delivered support.

Video #5 - Providing "just enough" support [1:30]

Key understandings

- Consider the student's abilities and needs before deciding on a form of support.
- Consider whether assistive technology or some additional instruction might help the student to participate more actively and/or independently in class activities.
- For some situations, peer support can be more effective and more enjoyable for the student than adult support.

<http://www.engagingalllearners.ca/sal/peer-mentoring/index.php?id=3>

Natural Supports - Too Much Support

In this short video clip, Dr. Erik Carter discusses some signs that may indicate too much adult support is being provided to a student.

Video #6 - Signs of too much support [1:21]

Key understandings

- Providing too much adult support can be a barrier to participating in social situations and learning activities in the classroom.
- It is also possible to provide too much peer support.
- It is important to provide just enough adult support to promote success but not so much that it interferes with independence and participation.

<http://www.engagingalllearners.ca/sal/peer-mentoring/index.php?id=3>

Fading Supports - Ways to Step Back

- Pause before answering or helping.
- Schedule in advance a brief task or time period when you commit to no intervention no matter what (unless safety is compromised). See what happens. Reintroduce assistance only as needed
- Sit further away. If you have been within arm's reach, sit just within earshot. If you have been sitting just within earshot, sit across the room.
- Take data instead. Keep a tally of the number of times in a lesson students appropriately go to their teacher instead of you.
- Call on the student's learning partner (buddy).

Fading Supports - Ways to Step Back

- Catch yourself before you correct students' work. Remember, this is about students' skills not yours.
- Teach students to decline assistance, "Thanks, but please let me try it by myself."
- Phase out cues.
- Have students discreetly ask their classmates for information: "what page are we on?"
- Remind yourself that you are stepping back so that students can become independent. It's harmful when you cover for them.

Fading Supports - Ways to Step Back

- Make sure that the team members know why you are stepping back, so it doesn't seem like you are shirking your responsibilities.
- Clock how long it takes for students to do things independently, such as the extra time needed to start zippers, pick up dropped papers, or find page numbers
- Let the classroom teacher serve as a clearinghouse for all questions or needs. Students ask their teachers. The classroom teacher then decides next steps
- Let your students make mistakes and get into trouble. It's part of the human experience!